

LCD Monitor Test



Constellation launch

Seagate launches its Constellation ES series of drives with capacities starting from 500 GB to 2 TB



Samsung Lavender

Samsung launches its stylish new Lavender Series of LCD Monitors available in 21.3 and 23-inch sizes

pivot, portrait mode), stands. All the high-end panel-based NEC displays have two DVI ports – one DVI-D (digital) and one DVI-I (analogue and digital). These, and the MultiSync 1990FXp were the only exceptions with a single DVI-D port. The 1990FXp has the same menu system as the 24- and 26-inch NECs but the up/down selection buttons are on the bottom bezel along with the right/left buttons. This creates confusion when using the menus, for while all the controls have legends onscreen that indicate their usage, the button layout is not intuitive, unlike the excellent menu layout

on the larger NEC displays and the 1990SX. The reason for not having the up/down buttons on the vertical portion of the bezel is apparent when one considers the slimness of the bezel – the thinnest in the entire test.

The Samsung D190 has a nifty photo-frame type stand though it's not very stable. ViewSonic's VA1928wm is the simpleton amongst the 19-inch displays – it has a decent plain black finish but there's nothing really attractive about it. The AOC831s looks neat with a nice piano black design and a lower bezel that droops towards the middle.

Performance

The NEC 1990SX has very wide viewing angles owing to the S-IPS panel used. Slight backlight bleeding was noticed at all four corners although unevenly; for example, it was really noticeable at the bottom right corner while at the top left corner was barely noticeable. This monitor has great brightness levels. It didn't do as well in the gaming tests, and *Crysis*' colours didn't look as crisp and lovely as on the other S-IPS panels. It's very good for viewing movies, but we didn't like the aspect ratio; this is the reason we deducted extra points in

the movie test. The same goes for the NEC 1990FXp – a good panel with an amazing contrast ratio that brought the shadows in *F.E.A.R* to life and made playing the game a fun experience.

The AOC F19 did very well with *Crysis*, with some good environment detail and the colours looked really crisp. *F.E.A.R*. wasn't as good because of its problems with reproducing accurate shadows – it doesn't do as well with lower intensity shades. The Samsung D190 has a good contrast ratio, but the resolution of 1360 x 768 is not perfect for every type of application. The simple ViewSonic VA1928wm did quite well. Post calibration, this was one of the few displays that actually seemed to have cooler looking colours, most of the other monitors seemed to look a little warmer after calibration. It's got a decent colour gamut for a TN panel, with a good rendition of green. For movies, we were surprised that it was quite good and displayed good colour and very decent contrast. There was a problem with backlight bleeding though at the top and the right side. *F.E.A.R*. looked good and with good contrast. *Crysis* had good colours.

Conclusion

The ViewSonic VA1928wm impressed us till we saw the price – at Rs. 8,200 it's pretty close to many 22-inch monitors. AOC's F19 steals its thunder though; a price of just Rs. 6,500 and performance that was marginally better than the VA1928wm. The F19 wins our Best Buy and we heartily recommend this monitor for anyone looking at something for movies. If you want something to game on, then the ViewSonic VA1928WM makes more sense with its 16:10 aspect ratio. For someone looking for professional monitors where colour accuracy is of utmost importance, NEC's duo of the 1990SX and the 1990FXp fit the bill, but are pricey.

Buying Guide

You Need

A high-end panel, you're a gamer with a unlimited budget and a GeForce GTX 295

We Recommend



NEC MultiSync 2690WUXi
Rs. 90,000

You Need

A large screen for gaming, maximum budget of Rs 20000

We Recommend



AOC 2434Pw
Rs. 14,500

You Need

A 22-inch panel for gaming and movies

We Recommend



AOC 2230Fm
Rs. 14,000
AOC F22
Rs. 8,800

You Need

A really affordable LCD for multimedia

We Recommend



AOC F19
Rs. 6,500

You Need

A monitor that I can use as a TV and one that has multiple connects

We Recommend



LG M237WA
Rs. 17,990

You Need

A large monitor for a photo studio - colour accuracy is of utmost importance

We Recommend



NEC MultiSync 2690WUXi
Rs. 90,000
NEC MultiSync 2490WUXi²
Rs. 83,000